Code You Never Write: A Crash Course

Foundations (Everyone), Chapter 5/10 — Revision & Viva-Prep Cheatsheet (English + Roman Urdu)
Source: agentfactory.panaversity.org/docs/code-you-never-write-crash-course

EN: Make AI your developer for real, tedious work -- without ever writing or reading code yourself. You are the client, not the contractor. Code is just exact instructions; you don't choose the language, the AI does.
Roman Urdu: AI ko real tedious work ka developer banao -- bina khud code likhe/parhe. Aap client ho, contractor nahi. Code sirf exact instructions hain; language aap nahi, AI choose karta hai.

1. The Deal

- Code isn't gated by coding skill -- AI is the developer, you're the client. Code = exact instructions (Python vs JS/TS -- you don't choose the language).
- VPRF signals help tell an 'answer problem' apart from a 'code problem'.

2. Hands Move + The Brief

- 3 lines to avoid automatic estimates: write+run the code (not just describe it), show the code, show row-counts-first.
- **5-section brief:** Goal, Input, Output, Rules, Edge cases -- Rules and Edge cases are the pair beginners skip.

3. Verify, Errors, Keep

- **5-check verification ladder:** known-answer test, reality questions, plain-English replay, adversarial pass, cross-model check.
- Treat errors as dialogue -- paste the red text back. Keep script + brief + sample data together in one folder.

4. Five Surfaces + Blast Radius

- Claude.ai/ChatGPT/Gemini (zero-risk sandbox), Claude Code/OpenCode (agent in a folder, terminal), Cowork/OpenWork (plan-then-approve desktop apps).
- **4 blast-radius rules:** work on copies, dry-run first, use the smallest folder, output goes to new files.
- Edge of one-prompt code: multi-user software, unattended automation, no-undo actions, judgment disguised as computation.

Key Terms Cheatsheet

One line each — English + Roman Urdu.

Term	English	Roman Urdu
VPRF signals	Cues that distinguish an 'answer problem' from a 'code problem'.	Signals jo 'answer problem' ko 'code problem' se alag batate hain.
5-section brief	Goal, Input, Output, Rules, Edge cases.	Goal, Input, Output, Rules, Edge cases.
5-check verification ladder	Known-answer, reality questions, plain-English replay, adversarial pass, cross-model.	Known-answer, reality questions, plain-English replay, adversarial pass, cross-model.
Blast radius	How much damage a mistake in the code could cause.	Code ki galti kitna damage kar sakti hai.
You are the client, not the contractor	Your job is to specify and verify, not to write code.	Aapka kaam specify/verify karna hai, code likhna nahi.

Quick Self-Check

Question	Answer
What are the 2 most commonly skipped sections of the 5-section brief?	Rules and Edge cases.
What are the 4 blast-radius rules before running AI-written code on real data?	Work on copies, dry-run first, use the smallest folder, send output to new files.
What's the 'plain-English replay' verification check?	Having the AI explain the code's logic in plain English to catch mismatches between intent and implementation.
What kinds of tasks sit at the edge of safe one-prompt code?	Multi-user software, unattended automation, no-undo actions, and judgment disguised as computation.

Where This Leads / Sources

Leads to: 4 practice projects (Money Detective, What's My Grade Really, The Books Don't Match, Photo Gallery Rescue). Full 32-Q quiz in 07-test-your-understanding.md.

Source: docs/code-you-never-write-crash-course/ (this repo), content originally via Zia Tutor AI connector.